

CONSTITUTION OF THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF RAMALLAH, PALESTINE

ARTICLE I – NAME

Section 1.

The name of this organization shall be the American Federation of Ramallah, Palestine (“A.F.R.P.”).

Section 2.

The A.F.R.P. headquarters shall be at 27484 Ann Arbor Trail, Westland, MI 48185.

Section 3.

The A.F.R.P. is a non-profit corporation chartered in the State of Michigan and recognized by the IRS.

ARTICLE II – PURPOSE AND MISSION

The purpose and mission of the A.F.R.P. shall be:

Section 1.

We are a non-profit charitable educational American-Palestinian organization whose proud members derive their ancestry from the original family from the city of Ramallah, Palestine.

Our objective is to serve our membership and the Palestinian, Arab, non-Arab, and charitable communities in the United States and abroad.

Our mission is to perpetuate the Ramallah family by means of providing educational, humanitarian, financial, charitable, and cultural programs as well as social interaction, and, to enhance and promote the interaction of its members to the Arabic culture and to promote our culture and heritage to those outside our community and the American public at large, and to descendants of Ramallah living throughout the world. Our mission is to be accomplished as provided for within the By-Laws.

ARTICLE III – AFFILIATION

Section 1.

The A.F.R.P. may affiliate with other organizations as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 2.

The Hathihe Ramallah Magazine (the “Magazine”) is recognized as the official media source for communication among

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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Approved July 13th, 2024

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the members of the A.F.R.P. A.F.R.P. It is acknowledged that the Magazine shall operate independently with its own editorial staff and subscription management as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 3.

The Ramallah Foundation, Inc. (the “Foundation”) is recognized as a separate and legal entity with the mission of supporting its own approved mission and constitution.

Section 4*

The American Ramallah Federation Educational and Charitable Fund (“ARFECF”) is recognized as a separate and legal entity with the mission of supporting its own approved mission and By Laws.

ARTICLE IV – LOCAL CHAPTERS

Section 1.

Local clubs are chapters (“Chapters”) of the A.F.R.P. and shall effectuate the purpose of the A.F.R.P. as provided for within the By-Laws. The Constitution and By-Laws of any Chapter shall not conflict with the A.F.R.P.’s Constitution or By-Laws.

ARTICLE V – GOVERNMENT

Section 1.

The governing body of the A.F.R.P. shall be vested in a Board of Directors (the “Board”) as defined by Article VI of the By-Laws and shall receive its authority from the General Assembly at a duly called for Annual Meeting. The requirements for service as a Board member are provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 2.

Executive Committee members shall be elected and shall hold their office in the manner provided for within the By-Laws, or until any successor(s) are duly elected or appointed and installed, as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 3**

The Board of Directors may seek and retain the services of the Executive Director whose duties, terms of employment and the process of selection and hiring are provided for within the By Laws. Further, the Executive Director shall reside in the Headquarters metro area.

ARTICLE VI – BY-LAWS

Section 1.

The A.F.R.P. shall be administered pursuant to its By-Laws, which shall not conflict with this Constitution.

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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ARTICLE VII – MEMBERSHIP

Section 1.

Regular Membership shall be available as provided for within the By-Laws.

Associate Membership shall be available as provided for within the By-Laws.

ARTICLE VIII – COMMITTEES

Section 1*

Standing Committees shall be: the Council of Past Presidents; the Council of Local Club Presidents; the Fund Raising Committee; the Investment Committee; the Finance Committee; the Program Development Committee; the Strategic Plan Committee; the Young Leader Committee; the Ramallah Business and Professional Network Committee; the Constitution Committee; the Selection Committee; the Membership Committee, the Young Adults Program Committee, and the Youth Program Committee. These Standing Committees shall operate pursuant to the By-Laws.

Section 2.

Other Committees shall be created and operate as provided for within the By-Laws.

ARTICLE IX – MEETINGS

Section 1.

The Annual General Meeting and the Mid-Year Meeting shall be held once a year as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 2.

The Board shall meet at least six (6) times each year as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 3.

The Executive Committee shall meet monthly and as called for by the President as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 4.

Roberts Rules of Order revised, shall govern the proceedings of all regular or special meetings of the A.F.R.P. and its constituent parts, except as provided in the By-Laws.

ARTICLE X – DISSOLUTION

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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Section 1.

Upon dissolution of the A.F.R.P., all assets shall be disposed of as provided for within the By-Laws.

ARTICLE XI – AMENDMENTS

Section 1.

This Constitution supersedes in all respects, the A.F.R.P.'s previous Constitution; and, upon adoption the previous Constitution is concurrently revoked and rescinded.

Section 2.

This Constitution may be repealed or amended upon an affirmative two-thirds (2/3) delegate vote at the Annual General Meeting as provided for within the By-Laws.

Section 3.

In order for a proposed amendment to be voted upon a (as provided in Article XI, § 2, *above*), not less than 60 days prior to the Annual General Meeting, notice of the proposed amendment shall be sent to all Chapters.

BY-LAWS OF THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF RAMALLAH, PALESTINE

ARTICLE I – NAME

By-Law 1.1

This organization shall be named as stated within the Constitution.

By-Law 1.2

Local clubs are chapters clubs ("Chapter Clubs") of the A.F.R.P., and shall affiliate with the A.F.R.P., in effectuating its purpose and mission.

ARTICLE II – PURPOSE AND MISSION

By-Law 2.1

The Purpose and Mission of the A.F.R.P shall be accomplished through:

* amended July 5, 2012
** amended July 7, 2012
*** amended November 1, 2017
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1. Providing financial and local community support that help to nurture, and develop those American Government initiatives that lead to a just and lasting peace in our ancestral homeland of Palestine.
2. Establishment of an organizational structure headed by an Executive Director that will serve the A.F.R.P.'s Executive Committee and Board of Directors.
3. To provide community outreach and cultural education.
4. Continued funding and the development of new initiatives and activities that afford A.F.R.P. members with Business and Professional skills.
5. Strengthening ties between the Chapter Clubs and the A.F.R.P. through increased participation in the Executive Committee and various Operating Committees.
6. To serve society through volunteerism and community service efforts.

ARTICLE III – AFFILIATION

By-Law 3.1

Any Chapter Club in the U.S. shall affiliate with the A.F.R.P. and must do so with the approval of the A.F.R.P. A member of any Chapter Club may be deemed a member of the A.F.R.P., provided they qualify for A.F.R.P. membership and are members in Good Standing according to By-Law 4.3.1. Each Chapter Club shall adopt its own governing laws, provided that these laws do not conflict with the Constitution and By-Laws of the A.F.R.P. Each Chapter Club shall also remain in good standing with all State and Federal regulations.

By-Law 3.2

A Chapter Club must complete an affiliation form which shall include all officers, names, addresses, phone numbers, and e-mail contacts, to be provided by August 1 of each year to the Federation Office.

ARTICLE IV – MEMBERSHIP

4.1 – Regular Membership

By-Law 4.1.1

Regular Membership in the A.F.R.P. shall be open to every person who has attained the age of 18 years and derives his or her origin from ancestral Ramallah (as defined within Aziz Shaheen's book entitled "Ramallah"), or one who is married to one having such origin ("Regular Membership").

4.2 – Associate Membership

By-Law 4.2.1

Associate Membership shall be available to those who do not fulfill the requirements of By-Law 4.1.1, *above*, but who, due to special circumstances, is approved by majority vote of the Board of Directors after recommendation by the Membership Committee (“Associate Membership”). An Associate Membership is a non-voting membership; therefore, Associate Members are ineligible to vote on any A.F.R.P. matters.

4.3 – Member in Good Standing

By-Law 4.3.1 **

A member in Good Standing (“Good Standing”) is one that adheres to and complies with the Constitution and By-Laws of the A.F.R.P., and has paid his/her AFRP and Local Club (if any) current membership year Annual Dues.

ARTICLE V – MEMBERSHIP DUES

By-Law 5.1*****

The amount(s) and structure of the Annual Membership Dues shall be determined by the Board of Directors from time to time. The membership year shall be from January 1 to December 31st (the “Membership Year”).

By-Law 5.2*****

Any registrant for the Annual Convention who qualifies for membership to the A.F.R.P. must pay their Annual Membership Dues prior to the Annual Convention, and payment of the Annual Membership Dues may be a condition to registration for the Annual Convention. The Annual Membership Dues are separate from, and in addition to, the Annual Convention registration fees. Registrants for the Annual Convention who are not eligible for A.F.R.P. membership may be required, in the sole discretion of the A.F.R.P., to remit a fee or donation to the A.F.R.P. prior to the Annual Convention or as a condition to registration for the Annual Convention; such fee or donation is separate from, and in addition to, the Annual Convention registration fees. Any Annual Membership Dues or other A.F.R.P. fees and donations collected by representatives of the host city for the Annual Convention must be promptly remitted to the General Treasurer of the A.F.R.P. Such amounts do not constitute, nor do they offset, the Annual Convention proceeds retained by the host city. Thirty (30) days before the Annual Convention, the General Treasurer of the A.F.R.P. shall provide the officials of the host city with a list of member names whose dues are paid for the current year of the Annual Convention.

By-Law 5.3*****

Annual Membership Dues must be received at the A.F.R.P.'s office by, or postmarked by, April 30th of any year in order to be eligible to vote for the positions of Deputy President, Members At Large of the Board, members of the Scholarship Committee and members of the Executive Committee in such year.

ARTICLE VI – GOVERNMENT

By-Law 6.1

The General Assembly of Members in Good Standing at a duly called for Annual Meeting shall be considered the final and

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

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highest authority of the A.F.R.P. (the “General Assembly”). The General Assembly shall consider and act upon any and all matters brought before it, whether policy or administrative in nature, provided that such matters be consistent with and fall within the scope of the provisions of the Constitution and By-Laws.

6.2 – Board of Directors

By-Law 6.2.1

The Board of Directors (“Board” or “Board of Directors”) shall have the authority to manage, supervise and control all business and affairs of the A.F.R.P. The Board shall also have the authority to enact any Rules and Regulations it deems proper for implementing the provisions of the Constitution and By-Laws and in regulating the affairs and business of the A.F.R.P. Such Rules and Regulations shall require approval by a two-thirds (2/3) affirmative vote of all members of the Board of Directors.

By-Law 6.2.2

The Board of Directors shall consist of the following voting members: All members of the Council of Past Presidents; All members of the Council of Local Club Presidents; Four (4) members at large; Members of the Executive Committee; One (1) member of the Ramallah Business and Professional Network; One (1) member of the Young Leader Committee; One (1) member of the Magazine; and, one (1) member from the Ramallah Foundation, Inc.. The Board of Directors shall also consist of the following non-voting members: the Executive Director; and the Executive Assistant. The Board of Directors will elect one of their members at the Annual Convention to function as the official A.F.R.P. Historian for a three year term. The duties of the Historian will be defined by the Board. The Board, by means of a special election, can replace the Historian, as may be required.

By-Law 6.2.3

To be a member of the Board of Directors each member must be a member in Good Standing of the Federation and the Chapter Club, if a Chapter Club exists in his/her locality, and that member shall be deemed an ambassador of the A.F.R.P. in his or her community and shall cooperate with the A.F.R.P. in all matters and projects by promoting the A.F.R.P. interests, encouraging A.F.R.P. membership, implementing A.F.R.P. decisions, and attending to whatever is requested of them.

By-Law 6.2.4

Whenever possible, all members of the Board shall be polled by the Executive Assistant or by a designated member of the Executive Committee on all major issues concerning the A.F.R.P. Further, any Board member shall have the right to submit suggestions or recommendations to the Executive Committee and request that polling of all Board members be made, only if such request is approved by at least (5) five members of the Board. Board members who do not reply to the poll within the time prescribed shall be considered to abstain on the issue.

6.3 – Council of Past Presidents

By-Law 6.3.1

The Council of Past Presidents shall consist of all Past Presidents of the A.F.R.P. The A.F.R.P.’s immediate Past President

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

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shall serve as the chairperson of the Council of Past Presidents during the year following his/her presidency. To remain an active voting member of the Council of Past Presidents, members should attend three (3) of the preceding five (5) conventions and can not miss (not be in attendance) three (3) consecutive Midyear Meetings. The President each year shall compile a list of active Past Presidents eligible to vote on all matters requiring a Board vote. Their names shall be printed in the Annual Committee Directory under the sub-heading, Board members eligible to vote. Those Past Presidents removed from the Council for being inactive must petition the Board for reinstatement (moving to active voting status shall require 2/3's Board Approval).

6.4 – Council of Chapter Club Presidents

By-Law 6.4.1

The Council of Chapter Club Presidents, shall be chaired by the Deputy President, and shall consist of the Chapter Club Presidents from those Chapter Clubs that have complied with By-Law Article III.

6.5 – Members At Large

By-Law 6.5.1

In order be elected to the Board as a Member At Large, the Member At Large shall not be a Past President or a Local Chapter President. Members At Large shall be elected to the Board of Directors for a two (2) year term during the General Assembly of the Annual Convention. Members At Large shall serve on a staggered term basis. For 2009, there will be no election as the current six (6) Board of Directors at Large will be reduced to four (2) with two (2) having their term expiring in 2009.

By-Law 6.5.2

Any candidate seeking election to the Board as a Member At Large, shall submit their intention to seek election by submitting their name for consideration during the Mid-Year Meeting. Hathihe Ramallah Magazine will publicize this in advance. The candidate seeking election to the Board as a Member At Large need not be present at the Mid-Year Meeting in order to submit their name for consideration. Thereafter, during the Annual Convention, the General Assembly shall elect by vote through a secret ballot two (2) Members At Large to the Board who shall serve a two (2) year term.

6.6 – Ramallah Business and Professional Network

By-Law 6.6.1

The Ramallah Business and Professional Network Committee shall appoint one of its board members to the Board for a one (1) year term. The Ramallah Business and Professional Network shall not appoint one of its board members to the Board of Directors if the member is a past A.F.R.P. President. The appointment shall be made at the General Assembly of the Annual Convention.

6.7 – Hathihe Ramallah Magazine

By-Law 6.7.1

The Hathihe Ramallah Magazine (the "Magazine") shall be the official media source for information concerning the A.F.R.P., and the A.F.R.P. shall appropriate the necessary funds to guarantee its publication. Subscription fee collection

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

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and policy will be determined by the Magazine's independently selected Board in consultation with the Federation's Board of Directors. The Magazine shall appoint one of its board members to the Board for a one (1) year term. The appointment shall be made at the General Assembly of the Annual Convention.

6.8 – Ramallah Foundation, Inc.

By-Law 6.8.1

The Ramallah Foundation, Inc. shall appoint one of its board members to the Board for a one (1) year term. The appointment shall be made at the General Assembly of the Annual Convention.

ARTICLE VII – OFFICERS AND DUTIES

7.1 – The Executive Committee

By-Law 7.1.1*

The Executive Committee shall consist of the following members: the President; the Deputy President; the Executive Secretary; the Scholarship fund Secretary of the ARFECF; the Educational Fund Treasurer; the General Fund (Treasurer; Financial Secretary); the Legal Advisor; the President of ARFECF; the Executive Director; and the Executive Assistant. All members of the Executive Committee will be members of the Board (the Executive Director and Executive Assistant will be non-voting members).

By-Law 7.1.2*

Members of the Executive Committee (except for the Executive Director and the Executive Assistant and officials of ARFECF) shall be elected during the General Assembly of the Annual Convention and shall serve during the interval between Conventions, or until successors are chosen at a regular meeting of the Board of Directors. The term of office for the Executive Committee will be as provided for in By-Law 9.3.3

7.2 – The President

By-Law 7.2.1

The President shall be the principal Executive Officer of the A.F.R.P. He/she shall preside at all general membership meetings and the Board of Directors. In general, he/she shall perform all the duties incident to the office of the President including the establishment of committees and such other duties as may be prescribed by the Constitution, the By-Laws, or the Board of Directors. The President is an ex officio member of all committees.

By-Law 7.2.2

In order to be elected President, the candidate must be a duly elected Deputy President and have served in that capacity during the preceding year.

By-Law 7.2.3

The President maximum authorization limit for operating expenditures not included in the annual budget shall not exceed

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** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

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\$2,000 and s/he will be able to exercise this privilege a maximum of twice during their term of office. Any expenditure in excess of \$2,000 shall only be authorized by the majority of the Board. Any expenditure in excess of \$10,000 shall only be authorized in the approved budget at the Annual General Meeting.

7.3 – The Deputy President

By-Law 7.3.1

In the absence of the President, or in the event of his/her inability or refusal to act, the Deputy President shall perform the duties of the President. The Deputy President shall perform such other duties as from time to time may be assigned to him/her by the President or these By-Laws. Upon termination of the term of office of the President, the Deputy President shall automatically and without further notice succeed to the office of the President to fulfill the remaining term and shall assume his/her regular term at the next Annual General Meeting. The Executive Committee and the Board of Directors shall decide whether the President is unable or has refused to act.

By-Law 7.3.2

In order to be elected Deputy President, the candidate must be an active A.F.R.P. member for the prior Three (3) years and have served the Local Club and/or Federation in an elected or appointed position for Four (4) years. If a Chapter Club does not exist in his/her community, then s/he must have a proven record of service within the residing local community. The Deputy President shall not be elected from the same city as the President.

By-Law 7.3.3

The Deputy President shall be chairman of the Strategic Plan Committee and shall have the authority, with the approval of the Board of Directors, to appoint four (4) additional members to the Strategic Plan Committee. The Committee shall have the responsibility to implement and promote programs of the Strategic Plan.

7.4 – Executive Secretary

By-Law 7.4.1*****

The Executive Secretary shall reside in the Headquarters metro area, or any other area within the United States so long as his/her duties and responsibilities may be fully performed remotely from the city of such person's residence (determined in the sole discretion of the Board); and shall have charge and custody of, and be responsible for all A.F.R.P. files and records, in the absence of the Executive Assistant, take minutes of all Board and Executive Committee meetings, and coordinate office activities with the Executive Director and Executive Assistant. In general, the Executive Secretary shall perform all duties incident to the office of Executive Secretary and such other duties as from time to time may be assigned to him/her by the President or the Board.

7.5 – General Fund Treasurer

By-Law 7.5.1*****

The General Treasurer shall reside in the Headquarters metro area, or any other area within the United States so long as

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his/her duties and responsibilities may be fully performed remotely from the city of such person's residence (determined in the sole discretion of the Board), and shall have charge and custody of, and be responsible for all general A.F.R.P. funds, and sign and endorse any checks drawn by or payable to the A.F.R.P. (including physically signing and endorsing such checks, if necessary or appropriate), and submit reports on the A.F.R.P. treasury when requested to by the Board. In general, the General Treasurer shall perform all duties incident to the office of General Treasurer and such other duties as from time to time may be assigned to him/her by the President or the Board. The General Treasurer will be responsible for paying all of the A.F.R.P. invoices including payroll, insurance, taxes and all accounts payable. She/he will work closely with the Financial Secretary to prepare an income and expense statement, audit the bank accounts, and prepare a statement report of all accounts and assets of the A.F.R.P. She/he will co-sign checks with the Financial Secretary.

Financial Secretary

By-Law 7.5.2*****

The Financial Secretary shall reside in the Headquarter metro area, or any other area within the United States so long as his/her duties and responsibilities may be fully performed remotely from the city of such person's residence (determined in the sole discretion of the Board), and shall be responsible for collecting and receiving any income and giving receipt for any and all monies coming into the A.F.R.P. from any source. She/he will deposit such funds into an A.F.R.P. bank account. She/he will work closely with the General Treasurer to prepare an income and expense statement, audit bank accounts, and prepare a statement report of all accounts and assets of the A.F.R.P. She/he will co-sign checks issued by the General Treasurer.

7.6 – Scholarship Fund Secretary

By-Law 7.6.1*

The Scholarship Fund Secretary shall act as Secretary of the Federation Scholarship Committee, as well as any other duties assigned to him/her by the President.

7.7 – Educational Fund Treasurer

By-Law 7.7.1*****

The Educational Fund Treasurer shall reside in the Headquarters metro area, or any other area within the United States so long as his/her duties and responsibilities may be fully performed remotely from the city of such person's residence (determined in the sole discretion of the Board), and shall keep records of the funds of the Educational Fund as well as perform all other duties and responsibilities incident to distributing approved grants and scholarships. The Educational Fund Treasurer's signature on checks shall be countersigned by a person designated by the ARFECF Board Of Directors.

7.8 – Legal Advisor

By-Law 7.8.1

The Legal Advisor shall be the Chief Legal Officer of the Federation and shall be available at all times for legal consultation to the President, the Executive Committee, the Executive Director, the Board of Directors, and the General Assembly at

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

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the Annual Convention. The Legal Advisor may be elected from any community, and shall be a licensed attorney in good standing.

7.9 – Executive Director

By-Law 7.9.1

The Executive Director shall perform the duties as set forth within the terms and conditions of employment as defined by the Board.

By-Law 7.9.2*

The Executive Director should be a college graduate, with experience in Non-Profit administration and management. This position will require someone with strong organizational skills in order to effectuate the following, as an at will employee of the A.F.R.P.: Implementing and enforcing A.F.R.P. policy as directed by the Board of Directors; Work in close cooperation with the President and Executive Committee; Oversee program progress, and insure all programs are adhering to A.F.R.P. policy and directive as laid out in the Constitution and By-Laws as applicable; Oversee the day to day operations of all the A.F.R.P. appointed committees; Work in close cooperation with all Chapter Clubs to promote and assist with any A.F.R.P. projects; and, Assist and support the Finance Committee, Membership Committee, and Fundraising Committee in implementing Corporate, Foundation and Grant Funding campaigns.

By-Law 7.9.3*

The Executive Director shall also: Have access to all A.F.R.P. and Chapter Club records oversee the maintenance and safeguarding of all records; Coordinate all official approved A.F.R.P. communication that will be disseminated from the A.F.R.P. office; Shall work to implement an online newsletter (Published online biweekly) to update A.F.R.P. members of activities and A.F.R.P. news; Shall institute a Public Relations campaign to other Arab American Organizations as well as the General Public. Engage in marketing and advertising on behalf of the A.F.R.P.; and, Have responsibility for coordinating all media activities, and along with the Board of Directors will decide who will represent the A.F.R.P. with respect to any and all media interaction.

By-Law 7.9.4*

The Executive Director, after selection, interview and recommendation by the five (5) member Board Selection Committee (appointed by the President), will be hired by the Board and shall serve as an at-will employee of the A.F.R.P. Nothing contained within the Constitution, By-Laws, or the Employment Terms of the Executive Director shall create any expectation of employment beyond that of an at-will employee. The terms and conditions of employment will be developed by the Board Selection Committee and reviewed and approved by the Board.

By-Law 7.9.5

The Executive Director shall execute the necessary employment documents immediately upon being hired and shall abide by the terms and conditions contained within the employment documents.

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

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By-Law 7.9.6**

On an annual basis, the President, along with the Executive Committee shall meet quarterly in order to evaluate the performance of the Executive Director, and at the Annual Meeting the President shall make salary recommendations to the Board for approval.

By-Law 7.9.7**

Whenever the position of the Executive Director becomes vacant, the process of filling such position shall be initiated by the Board of Directors. Before the Selection Committee is appointed, the Board of Directors shall vote to make a determination as to the need and necessity of filling the position; and to determine whether the general fund has the funds to cover the expenses of hiring an Executive Director. Further, the candidate must agree in writing to work from the Federation's Headquarters office.

By-Law 7.9.8**

The President shall appoint a selection committee to proceed in the process of selecting and recommending to the Board of Directors the candidate for Executive Director together with the negotiated contract of employment for its approval by polling the entire Board of Directors.

By-Law 7.9.9**

As to other employees of the AFRP, the executive committee of the AFRP shall select and negotiate the contract of employment of such proposed employee and submit the same for the approval by the Board of Directors in its next regular meeting unless polling is requested by five members of the board.

By-Law 7.9.10**

Whenever there is a polling of the entire members of the Board of Directors to be taken who are in good standing is required. The passage of such polling shall be by simple majority of the votes casted. Abstaining and non-voting members of the Board of Directors shall not be counted.

7.10 – Executive Assistant

By-Law 7.10.1

The Executive Assistant, upon submission of a resume and after being interviewed and hired by the A.F.R.P., will be a non-voting member on the Board and Executive Committee. This position is to be funded by the Finance Committee and maybe combined with the Executive Director position as required. The Executive Assistant shall perform the duties set forth within these By-Laws.

By-Law 7.10.2*

The Executive Assistant should be a High School graduate (or GED equivalent), with experience in office administration. This position will require someone with organizational, typing, and communication skills in order to effectuate the following, as an at will employee of the A.F.R.P.: Working in close cooperation with the Executive Director in implementing

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all A.F.R.P. Board approved business; Shall oversee the organization and operation of the A.F.R.P. daily office activities with the Executive Director; and, shall take minutes of all Board and Executive Committee meetings, and maintain and safeguarding the A.F.R.P. records and documents.

By-Law 7.10.3

The Executive Assistant shall be an at-will employee of the A.F.R.P. Nothing contained within the Constitution, By-Laws, or the Employment Terms of the Executive Assistant shall create any expectation of employment beyond that of an at-will employee.

By-Law 7.10.4

The Executive Assistant shall execute the necessary employment documents immediately upon being hired and shall abide by the terms and conditions contained within the employment documents.

By-Law 7.10.5**

On an annual basis, the President, along with the Executive Committee shall meet quarterly in order to evaluate the performance of the Executive Assistant. At the Annual Meeting the President shall make salary recommendations to the Board for approval.

ARTICLE VIII – COMMITTEES

8.1 – Committee Creation

By-Law 8.1.1

Besides the creation of Committees mandated by the Constitution and By-Laws covering various activities, projects, contracts and purposes of the A.F.R.P., the President on his own initiative or the Board of Directors, or the General Assembly by majority vote, may create any committee needed in order to conduct of affairs of the A.F.R.P.

By-Law 8.1.2

All committee members shall be an A.F.R.P. member in Good Standing during the prior year of appointment and shall also be members in Good Standing of their Chapter Club if any, and shall remain so during the tenure of their office.

By-Law 8.1.3

Standing committee members shall serve for one year and shall be appointed by the President, except as otherwise specified within these By-Laws, after consultation with the Committee on Appointments (if necessary). The Chairperson of any created or mandated committee shall be appointed by the President, except as otherwise specified within these By-Laws.

8.2 – Standing Committees

By-Law 8.2.1*

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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The following Standing Committees are mandated by the Constitution: the Council of Past Presidents; the Council of Local Club Presidents; the Fund Raising Committee; the Investment Committee; the Finance Committee; the Program Development Committee; the Strategic Plan Committee as described In By-Law 7.3.3; the Young Leader Committee; the Ramallah Business and Professional Network Committee; the Constitution Committee; the Selection Committee; the Membership Committee; the Young Adults Program Committee; and, the Youth Program Committee and the Government Affairs Committee.

8.3 – Council of Past Presidents

By-Law 8.3.1

The Council of Past Presidents shall be comprised of all past A.F.R.P. Presidents. The Council of Past Presidents shall meet, at a minimum, two (2) times per year, in accordance with By-Law 10.4.1 and shall act in an advisory capacity to the Board.

8.4 – Council of Chapter Club Presidents

By-Law 8.4.1

The Council of Local Chapter Presidents shall be comprised of all Local Chapter Presidents. The Council of Local Chapter Club Presidents shall meet, at a minimum, two (2) times per year, in accordance with By-Law 10.5.1 and shall work along with the Executive Director in implementing any A.F.R.P. Chapter Club or other programs.

8.5 – Fundraising Committee

By-Law 8.5.1*

With the assistance of the Executive Director, the Fundraising Committee shall coordinate all A.F.R.P. fundraising programs and projects, including but not be limited to: Emergency Fundraising; Corporate Fundraising; Grants and Foundation; and, Federation Membership. The Fundraising committee shall be consist of nine (9) members elected from each region of the three regions of the Federation listed in Article X, By-Law 10.1.1, of these By-Laws. Each member shall be elected for a term of three (3) years. The committee shall be elected on a staggering basis with each three (3) members elected every year as to insure the continuity of the committee. Thus, the initial committee elected upon adoption of these By-Laws shall be elected in this manner: from each region the candidate receiving the highest vote shall serve for three (3) years, the second highest shall serve for two (2) years, and the third highest shall serve for one (1) year. Thereafter, every year the general assembly shall elect one member from each region to fill out the vacant seat.

Emergency Fundraising

By-Law 8.5.2

The Board or President may create as required a sub-committee of the Fundraising Committee in order to effectuate emergency fundraising. If a sub-committee is created for purposes of emergency fundraising, members of Emergency Fundraising sub-committee shall be appointed by the President, and with the assistance of the Executive Director who shall serve as the chairperson of said sub-committee, shall coordinate fundraising efforts as directed by the Board and President.

Corporate Fundraising

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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By-Law 8.5.3

The President shall create sub-committee of the Fundraising Committee in order to effectuate corporate fundraising. Members of Corporate Fundraising sub-committee shall be appointed by the President, and with the assistance of the Executive Director who shall serve as the chairperson of said sub-committee coordinate its fundraising efforts as directed by the Board.

Grants and Foundations

By-Law 8.5.4

The President shall create sub-committee of the Fundraising Committee in order to effectuate fundraising through Grants and Foundations. Members of the Grants and Foundations Fundraising sub-committee shall be appointed by the President, and with the assistance of the Executive Director who shall serve as the chairperson of said sub-committee coordinate its fundraising efforts as directed by the Board.

A.F.R.P. Membership

By-Law 8.5.5

The President shall create sub-committee of the Fundraising Committee in order to effectuate raising funds through A.F.R.P. Membership Dues. Members of the Federation Membership sub-committee shall be appointed by the President, and with the assistance of the Executive Director who shall serve as the chairperson of said sub-committee coordinate its fundraising efforts as directed by the Board.

8.6 – Investment Committee

By-Law 8.6.1

The Investment Committee shall be responsible for all A.F.R.P. investments and supporting development of the annual budgets for the A.F.R.P. and its Programs.

By-Law 8.6.2*

The Investment Committee shall consist of members within the categories as set in the Board's established Investment Committee policy.

8.7 – Finance Committee

By-Law 8.7.1

The Finance Committee shall review and study the finances of the Federation and propose the annual budget and submit recommendations thereon to the Board at the General Assembly, as the case may be during the year, for decisions or changes.

By-Law 8.7.2

The fiscal year of the A.F.R.P. shall be from June 1st to May 31st of the succeeding year.

8.8 – Program Development

By-Law 8.8.1

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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The Program Development Committee shall develop and implement A.F.R.P. programs including, but not limited to, Social, Cultural, and Educational programs/activities for members and Local Chapters of the A.F.R.P. The Program Development Committee shall also assist Convention cities to have events available at the Convention.

8.9 – Ramallah Business and Professional Network

By-Law 8.9.1

The Board of Directors shall establish the committee rules, regulations and policies as required.

8.10 – Constitutional Committee

By-Law 8.10.1

As described in Article XV – 16.1 Amendments to By-Laws.

The President shall appoint, with approval of the Board of Directors, the Young Leader Chairman and four (4) additional members to the Young Leader Committee. The Young Leader Chairman and committee members shall be alumnus of the A.F.R.P. Project Hope or Leadership Ramallah Programs. The Young Leader Committee shall help develop and implement Service and Leadership Programs for members and Local Chapters of the A.F.R.P.

8.11 – Committee on Appointments

By-Law 8.11.1

The Board shall select a Committee of at least three (3) members from the Board of Directors, excluding the members of the Executive Committee which shall be called the Board of Director's Committee on Appointments.

8.12 – Membership Committee

By-Law 8.12.1

The Membership Committee shall consist of one member from each community (generally the Local Club President or a representative) that has a Local Chapter, the Executive Assistant and the General Treasurer.

By-Law 8.12.2

The Membership Committee shall prepare and make available to members of the Ramallah community, applications for the purpose of joining the A.F.R.P. Such applications shall, *inter alia*, contain questions relative to the age, address and telephone number of the applicant, whether s/he was an A.F.R.P. member in previous years, whether s/he is a member in good standing in the Local Club in his or her community, if one exists, and place for signature. However, a letter with sufficient information to identify the applicant and members of his/her household with his/her signature shall be accepted as a membership application. All current members shall receive annual renewal of membership notices.

By-Law 8.12.3

In the event that a household comprises of more than one person qualified for membership and are desirous of becoming members, only one member of said household need sign on behalf of the other members of the household and pay their dues, provided that s/he lists their names and ages.

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

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By-Law 8.12.4**

The only dues to be accepted as valid for purposes of voting are those that are paid by credit card, check or money order from the applicant's personal or business fund, whether the applicant is an individual or a head of a household on behalf of himself or herself and those members of his or her own household, as the case may be.

By-Law 8.12.5*****

All membership applications, together with the Annual Membership Dues, shall be received at the A.F.R.P.'s office by, or postmarked by, April 30th of any year in order to be certified to vote in such year for the following positions: Deputy President, Members at Large of the Board, members of the Scholarship Committee and members of the Executive Committee.

By-Law 8.12.6

The Membership Committee shall soon thereafter prepare a membership list in alphabetical order for each community, separately, and furnish copies of each list to the Selection Committee and the Executive Assistant no later than May 10 of each year. Furthermore, by May 10 of each year, the custodian of the received membership applications shall turn over said applications to the Selection Committee for the purpose of verification after which the applications shall be returned to the Membership Committee.

By-Law 8.12.7*

The Executive Assistant shall keep the membership applications received by him/her in a safe place and upon approval by the Executive Committee shall make the list of membership available to other members of the Federation and ARFECF.

By-Law 8.12.8

Household is defined as husband and/or wife and unmarried children over the age of 18.

8.13 – Young Adult Programs Committee

By-Law 8.13.1

The Board of Directors shall establish the committee rules, regulations and policies as required.

8.14 – Youth Program Committee

By-Law 8.14.1

The Board of Directors shall establish the committee rules, regulations and policies as required.

8.15 – Other Committees

By-Law 8.15.1

The Board, President, or Executive Committee, may create any other committees in order to further the goals and purpose of the A.F.R.P.

* amended July 5, 2012
** amended July 7, 2012
*** amended November 1, 2017
**** amended July 3, 2021
*****amended July 13, 2024
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Governmental Affairs Committee: The Board of Directors shall establish a Governmental Affairs Committee to represent this organization In Washington, D.C. with the U.S. State Department, Congress of the United States, and the White House. The chairperson and members of this committee shall be appointed by the Board.

ARTICLE IX – VOTING AND ELECTIONS

9.1 – Delegate Voting

By-Law 9.1.1

Delegate voting during the General Assembly shall be required in the following instances:

1. If a delegate requests delegate voting on an issue, the President shall poll the Chairpersons designate of the Club delegates present in the meeting and if 15% or more of those polled favor delegate voting, in that event, delegate voting shall be conducted;
2. On voting for elective offices of the Federation and the Convention city, where a contest exists; or,
3. On matters involving amendments to the Constitution and By-Laws requiring vote by the General Assembly.

By-Law 9.1.2

On all other issues, except as provided for above in, § 1, *above*, voting during the general assembly shall be by voice voting or by a counting of raised hands of members present in the meeting.

By-Law 9.1.3

Other than the election of the Deputy President, each club or community shall have the right to send to the Convention a delegation consisting of one or more delegates. Each delegate will independently cast a proportionate number of votes equaling the total number of certified members from his/her Chapter Club divided by the number of delegates sent to the Convention; However, any certified member attending the Convention shall have the option to cast his/her vote independently in which case, his/her vote shall be deducted from the number of votes cast by the delegates representing his/her community.

By-Law 9.1.4

The number of votes that may be cast by any community shall be limited to the number of persons whose membership had been certified by the Selection Committee.

9.2 – Voting by Secret Ballot

By-Law 9.2.1

Within 30 days after receiving the list of certified memberships, the Selection Committee shall send to each certified member, individually, a ballot form with the names of candidates for the office of Deputy President together with a pre-

* amended July 5, 2012
** amended July 7, 2012
*** amended November 1, 2017
**** amended July 3, 2021
*****amended July 13, 2024
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addressed return envelope. The ballot shall also contain instructions to vote for one candidate only. The address of the return envelope shall be a Certified Public Accountant or independent agency chosen by the Election Committee.

By-Law 9.2.2

Upon receipt of the ballot form, each member shall make his or her free choice by voting for one candidate, insert the ballot in the envelope labeled "BALLOT", place same in the larger envelope, and mail and/or email it so as to reach the Certified Public Accountant or the independent agency postmarked no later than June 10 of each year. Envelopes and inserts shall be numbered as designated by the Selection Committee. The actual details of ballots, envelopes, sizes and place for signature shall be decided upon by the Selection Committee.

By-Law 9.2.3

The sealed envelopes of the ballot shall be kept intact with the CPA or the independent agency to be turned over to the Chairpersons of the Election and the Credentials Committees upon written request prior to the date of the Convention and shall not be opened until the election day of the Annual Convention.

By-Law 9.2.4

The candidate receiving the highest number of votes cast shall be declared the winner irrespective of the percentage of votes or the number of candidates. In case of a tie vote, the winner shall be decided by a draw from a bag under the direction of the Election Committee.

By-Law 9.2.5

A ballot that shows an erroneous vote for more than one candidate shall be disqualified and not counted.

9.3 – Eligibility for Elective Offices

By-Law 9.3.1**

All candidates, with the exception of the Deputy President, for any elective office, whether nominated by the Selection Committee or from the floor, shall be an A.F.R.P. member in Good Standing immediately after the election and throughout their term. Membership in their Chapter Club, if any, is also mandatory.

By-Law 9.3.2

Any member seeking to be nominated and elected shall be present at the Annual meeting. Exceptions to this provision shall be made where special circumstances may prevent attendance at the Annual Convention. What constitutes special circumstances shall be determined and decided by the President after consultation with the Legal Advisor; this decision shall be final.

By-Law 9.3.3

Each officer of the A.F.R.P. may be elected to the same office for a maximum of four (4) consecutive one (1) year terms in the same office, except the President, who shall not succeed himself/herself to the same office, but may be reelected three (3) years following his/her presidency.

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

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By-Law 9.3.4**

Any candidate for the position of Deputy President must meet with following minimal criteria:

1. The candidate must have been an A.F.R.P. member in good standing for the prior three years.
2. All candidates shall abide by the Constitution and By-Laws pertaining to conduct of the candidates, the qualifications, and the Rules and Regulations for campaigning.
3. ** Candidates for Deputy President shall submit their intention to run for Deputy President by registered letter or in person their written intention to the Selection Committee at the A.F.R.P. headquarters, stating their qualifications and intention to run, no later than February 28th. Any submission postmarked later than February 28th shall not be considered. Upon receipt of their application, the A.F.R.P. Board of Directors at large will evaluate the candidate's application and vote by a simple majority of voting members to approve the applicants as a qualified candidate within 15 days of receipt. If the applicant is approved, the application will be referred to the Selection Committee for certification. The Credentials Committee shall certify the eligibility of the candidate(s) no later than March 31th.
4. The candidate must have served the Local Club and/or Federation in an elected or appointed position for Four (4) years. If a Chapter Club does not exist in his/her community, then s/he must have a proven record of service within the residing local community. The Deputy President shall not be elected from the same city as the President.

By-Law 9.3.5

Membership and voting eligibility must be certified by the Selection Committee.

9.4 – Election Campaign

By-Law 9.4.1

In campaigning for any election, candidates shall abide by all these rules and regulations, and shall employ ethical standards, and moral principles. Candidates may campaign by promoting their personal qualifications, abilities, past achievements, and projected programs. Candidates shall and always keep in mind the interest of the A.F.R.P.; and, any candidate or any person acting on the candidate's behalf shall not solicit the vote of any member by resorting to unlawful means.

By-Law 9.4.2

If, upon a written complaint being made and investigated, the Selection Committee is satisfied that a candidate for the office of Deputy President, or anyone acting on his behalf, knowingly violates these By-Laws, Chairpersons of these Committees, individually or jointly, shall request the President to call for a meeting by the Board of Directors to deal with the complaint. If a violation is determined by the majority of the Board, by secret ballot, the candidate shall be immediately disqualified from the election.

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

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By-Law 9.4.3

No member shall accept from any candidate or from any person acting on his or her behalf any sum of money or other consideration to pay for his/her A.F.R.P. dues in lieu of voting for such candidate. Any such acts shall be deemed a violation and shall be taken by the Selection Committee as grounds for disqualifying the membership, vote of the members, and the candidate.

9.5 – Campaigning Rules

By-Law 9.5.1

Any candidate may send letters to Chapters Clubs or individuals announcing his/her candidacy and requesting support.

By-Law 9.5.2

Candidates are encouraged to present his/her platform by submitting an article to the Manager of the Magazine for publication. Any submitted article shall conform to the criteria set forth by the Magazine staff.

By-Law 9.5.3

Candidates shall be given the opportunity to address the Board of Directors during the Mid-Year meeting.

By-Law 9.5.4

All Candidates, their committees and supporters, must conduct themselves in a professional manner consistent with the Constitution and By-Laws.

By-Law 9.5.5

The A.F.R.P. prohibits the payment of membership dues on behalf of others (except members of their own families [families to mean husband and wife, their children and their spouses]), and discourages candidates from excessive spending during the campaign.

By-Law 9.5.6

Candidates are encouraged to offer constructive criticism and ideas for the betterment of the A.F.R.P., and the community at large.

ARTICLE X – MEETINGS

10.1 – Annual Meeting

By-Law 10.1.1

The Annual Meeting of the general membership shall be held during the Annual Convention. Convention locations are selected two (2) years in advance, by the general membership meeting during the Annual Convention. Only Regular Members in good standing shall have the right to vote at the Annual meeting. Any city bidding for a Convention must have

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

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at least 50 paid members for at least 5 consecutive years. A bid for a Convention must be submitted in writing by the Mid-Year Meeting to be considered by the General Assembly. The Local Chapters shall be divided into three (3) geographical regions. Region 1: San Francisco, San Jose, San Diego, Los Angeles, and Houston; Region 2: Detroit, Chicago, Cleveland, New York and Louisville/Lexington; Region 3: Jacksonville, Birmingham, Knoxville, and Washington, D.C. Each year the Convention location will rotate between these three regions. A Convention cannot return to a region within a three year period. If a region elects not to host a Convention during its turn in the rotation, it will forfeit the right until the next rotation.

By-Law 10.1.2*****

Reserved.

By-Law 10.1.3*****

Reserved.

By-Law 10.1.4

Announcement of the date of the coming Convention printed in the Magazine shall be deemed sufficient notice of the location and date of the Annual Meeting of the general membership, provided that such notice is given at least sixty (60) days prior to the date of the Convention.

By-Law 10.1.5

At the annual meeting duly called by the President or the Executive Committee, during the Convention, Twenty Five (25) paid members shall be deemed to be have a quorum and may transact any business that comes before it and elect officers regardless of the percentage of members present, or delegates holding votes of absentee members.

By-Law 10.1.6

The Convention is a function of the A.F.R.P. The rights, responsibilities and obligations of the host city and the A.F.R.P. are derived from the Convention Contract Guidelines and are subject to the terms and conditions contained within said guidelines.

By-Law 10.1.7

The President shall appoint a Convention Liaison to oversee, and report on, Pre-Convention planning and Post-Convention accounting. The Convention Liaison shall be a member of the Council of Past Presidents. The final accounting must be submitted to the A.F.R.P. office no later than 120 days after the Convention.

10.2 – Mid-Year Meeting

By-Law 10.2.1*****

The Board of Directors shall convene at a Mid-Year meeting to be held in Detroit, Michigan, or elsewhere in the USA as

* amended July 5, 2012
** amended July 7, 2012
*** amended November 1, 2017
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approved by the Executive Committee, in order to review A.F.R.P. activities, and to formulate proposals for the forthcoming Convention. The Mid-Year meeting shall be attended by the following officials:

- A. Reserved;
- B. The members of the Executive Committee;
- C. Members of the Council of Past Presidents;
- D. The Committee Chairpersons of any A.F.R.P. committee or a designated representative;
- E. A Committee member from the forthcoming host Convention city;
- F. The Executive Director and Executive Assistant; The A.F.R.P. shall reimburse their transportation and lodging expenses;
- G. The President of the Ramallah Foundation, Inc., or a designated representative; and
- H. A representative of Hathihe Ramallah Magazine, or a designated representative.

10.3 – Meetings, Board of Directors

By-Law 10.3.1

During the interval between Conventions, the Board of Directors shall meet a minimum of six (6) times per year, inclusive of the Mid-Year and Convention. A majority of those present (in person or otherwise) shall be needed to discuss and transact Federation business.

10.4 – Meetings, Council of Past Presidents

By-Law 10.4.1

The Council of Past Presidents shall meet a minimum of two (2) times per year, inclusive of the Mid-Year Meeting and Convention. A majority of those present (in person or otherwise) shall be needed to discuss and provide recommended actions of proposals to the AFRP Board for review and approval as required.

10.5 – Meetings, Council of Chapter Club Presidents

By-Law 10.5.1

The Council of Chapter Club Presidents shall meet a minimum of two (2) times per year, inclusive of the mid year and convention. A majority of those present (in person or otherwise) shall be needed to discuss and transact any A.F.R.P. business.

10.6 –Right To Vote

By-Law 10.6.1

Whether in the Mid-Year Meeting or in the regular or special meetings of the Board of Directors, only members of the Board shall have the right to vote on any matter requiring a vote.

ARTICLE XI – AUTHORITY TO BIND

11.1 – Contracts and Funds

By-Law 11.1.1

The Executive Committee and Board acting jointly may authorize any officer or officers or Board member(s) to negotiate any contract or execute and deliver any instrument in the name and on behalf of the A.F.R.P. and such other authority may be general or confirmed to special instances. The Executive Committee Including the legal advisor must approve the final language before contract execution.

By-Law 11.1.2

All checks, drafts or orders for payment of money, notes or other evidence of indebtedness issued in the name of the A.F.R.P., shall be signed by the Treasurer and countersigned by a senior officer of the Executive Committee of the home office.

By-Law 11.1.3

The Executive Committee and the Board of Directors may accept, on behalf of the A.F.R.P., any contributions, gifts, bequest or devise for the general purposes or for any special purpose of the A.F.R.P.

By-Law 11.1.4

A Chapter Club or member of the A.F.R.P. shall not solicit any funds in their individual capacity for any project already undertaken by the A.F.R.P. unless authorized to do so by the Board and Executive Committee.

By-Law 11.1.5

All funds raised for an A.F.R.P. sponsored project from each Local Club/Chapter must be sent through the Federation's main headquarters office to then be forwarded to the respective organization/ individual.

ARTICLE XII – PROCEDURE AT MEETINGS

By-Law 12.1

On Parliamentary procedure not covered in the Constitution or By-Laws, Robert's Rules of Order shall govern during A.F.R.P. meetings.

* amended July 5, 2012
** amended July 7, 2012
*** amended November 1, 2017
**** amended July 3, 2021
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By-Law 12.2

During the Annual General Meeting and Mid-Year Meeting, the President shall appoint a Parliamentarian, other than the Legal Advisor, to resolve all questions of order. The decision of the Parliamentarian is final.

ARTICLE XIII – REMOVAL FROM OFFICE

By-Law 13.1

Any officer, director or member may be removed from office or from membership as a result of failure to fulfill the duties of their office, or for conduct detrimental to the best interest of the A.F.R.P.

By-Law 13.2

Any elected officer who, during his/her tenure of office loses his/her status as a Member in Good Standing in the A.F.R.P. or his Chapter Club, if any, shall be removed and replaced by a one appointed by the President.

ARTICLE XIV – POLICY, PURPOSE AND ADMINISTRATION

The Board of Directors shall establish policy, purpose and administration as required.

ARTICLE XV – DISSOLUTION

15.1 – Dissolution of Chapter Club

By-Law 15.1.1

In the event a Chapter Club should dissolve its membership, and no longer be considered a Chapter Club of the A.F.R.P., then all assets of the Chapter Club shall revert to the A.F.R.P. for its sole possession.

15.2 – Dissolution of the A.F.R.P

By-Law 15.2.1

Prior to Dissolution, a Committee of seven (7) Trustees shall be established as appointed by the Board. The Committee shall be comprised of the President, Deputy President, Legal Advisor, two (2) representatives who have served on the Board, and two (2) representatives who have served on the Executive Committee.

By-Law 15.2.2

Duties of the Committee shall include assembly, as some secure site, of all physical assets of the A.F.R.P. An accurate inventory shall be prepared and the assets placed in secure storage for a period not to exceed ninety (90) days.

By-Law 15.2.3

* amended July 5, 2012
** amended July 7, 2012
*** amended November 1, 2017
**** amended July 3, 2021
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All monetary assets, including all market investments and investment accounts shall be liquidated and combined, and the funds shall be used to purchase a ninety (90) day Certificate of Deposit in the name of the A.F.R.P.

By-Law 15.2.4

All existing records such as minutes of meetings, documents, printed materials, books and the like as deemed appropriate by the Trustees, shall be assembled and itemized verifying their existence. These records shall also be placed in secure storage for a period not to exceed ninety (90) days.

By-Law 15.2.5

Should no effort be made to revive the A.F.R.P. within the ninety-day period, all physical assets shall be converted into cash by the Trustees, and along with the monetary assets shall be invested in a five (5) year Certificate of Deposit.

By-Law 15.2.6

Should the A.F.R.P. not be re-activated within the five-year period, the funds, together with all accrued interest, shall be used to fund Educational Scholarships of any of its members, as defined in By-Law 4.1.1. Criteria for such Scholarships shall be the responsibility of the same Trustees who handled the dissolution, insofar as is possible.

By-Law 15.2.7

Should any original Trustee not be available or able to serve, a substitute from the same organization shall be invited to act in his/her place.

By-Law 15.2.8

It should be clearly understood that the role of the Trustees is, in this instance, a voluntary one and there is not monetary compensation forthcoming.

ARTICLE XVI – AMENDMENT

16.1 – Amendments to By-Laws

By-Law 16.1.1

Any member in Good Standing shall have the right to submit amendments to the By-Laws by mailing or emailing same to the Executive Director/Assistant at least sixty (60) days before the date set for the next General Assembly Meeting at the Convention. The Executive Assistant shall mail and/or email all proposed amendments received by him/her to the Chairman of the Constitutional Committee. Following the Constitutional Committee review and recommendation, the proposed amendments shall be provided to the AFRP Board and to the members of the Council of Chapter Club Presidents at least forty five (45) days before the date set for the next General Assembly Meeting at the Convention, who shall discuss such amendments with their Chapter Clubs. The Constitutional Committee shall submit its recommendations for or against to the general assembly. A two-thirds (2/3) majority delegate vote of the general assembly shall be required for passage

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

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of any proposed amendment.

Article XVII – Selection Committee

By-law 17.1.1

The selection committee is more robust, powerful and influential than in the past: it is responsible for screening, vetting and approving every individual recommended for a vacant Federation seat, including standing committee chairs, committee members, Executive Committee members, Deputy President, and Constitution-ratified program chairs per the Constitution.

By-law 17.1.2

The Executive Committee will be charged with presenting a slate of candidates to the Board of Directors, reflecting the Federation's diversity, in geography, age, gender, family/clan and experience level. The candidate slate will be drawn from around the country, based on individuals' contributions – past, present, and projected - passion for the Mission, knowledge, skills, and abilities. In the spirit of equity, no more than two individuals from the same city will be permitted. Nine individuals will be chosen

By-law 17.1.3

Local Club presidents will be asked to submit one to two recommendations, and these individuals' names will be submitted by the President to the Executive Committee for consideration.

One group of three will have a one-year term; the second group of three will have a two-year term, the third group will have a three-year term. Members will be eligible for reappointment to a second term, but their service may not exceed six years (two consecutive terms).

By-law 17.1.4

There are several responsibilities outlined for the committee chair and committee members. Advertise and recruit for committee chairs and members, Executive Committee seats, program chairs and members, and the Deputy President using all Federation platforms available. Guarantee deadline compliance of submissions and review all applications. Rank three top candidates based on merits.

For all positions except the Deputy President, the top three candidates will be interviewed by the full committee, and the committee will debrief their findings upon interview completion. In the context of the Deputy President, the committee shall make its recommendations for the candidate slate to be presented for Election to the membership.

The full proposal includes Job descriptions for the Selection Committee Chair and Committee members. Please review the Strategic Planning Proposal for the full details of the committee's description and members responsibilities.

* amended July 5, 2012

** amended July 7, 2012

*** amended November 1, 2017

**** amended July 3, 2021

*****amended July 13, 2024

AFRP Office

Approved July 13th, 2024

Jacksonville Convention